

INTERNAL ASSESSMENT NOTE

Areas of Concern — Batch 2025–27

Consolidated feedback from alumni reviewers — Post-PPM 1 (Pre-Placement Mock Round 1)

Field	Detail
Batch under review	2025–27
Source of feedback	Alumni panellists who conducted PPM 1 interviews
Nature of round	Mock personal interview / domain and behavioural assessment
Prepared for	Faculty, placement committee and batch representatives
Purpose	To document recurring weak points and enable corrective action before subsequent rounds

1. Context and Purpose

This note consolidates the observations shared by alumni reviewers following the first Pre-Placement Mock (PPM 1) round for the batch of 2025–27. The reviewers were alumni currently working in industry, and their feedback reflects the standard against which the batch will be evaluated in live placement processes.

The intent of this document is not to assign blame but to create a shared, written record of where the batch currently stands so that preparation effort can be redirected. A recurring theme across reviewers was that the faculty is investing considerable effort in preparation, but that effort is not translating into visible improvement in interview performance — which points to a gap in student ownership rather than in the quality of instruction.

2. Summary of Key Findings

Reviewers flagged nine broad areas of weakness. In descending order of severity as reported:

#	Weak Area	Severity / Nature of Gap
1	Structured thinking	Critical — answers are unstructured; case studies and guesstimates are largely unpracticed
2	Basic telecom / domain knowledge	Critical — eTOM not known even at foundational level, against a Level 3 expectation
3	Articulation and communication	Critical — poor delivery, weak vocabulary, minimal use of business terminology

#	Weak Area	Severity / Nature of Gap
4	Situational and behavioural responses	Critical — responses are vague, reactive and lack a decision framework
5	Work experience articulation	High — no quantification, no mapping to frameworks
6	Certifications without depth	High — credentials listed but content not understood
7	Technical knowledge	High — shallow understanding across technical fundamentals
8	Attitude and learning orientation	High — laid-back approach; reluctance to engage with emerging technology
9	Inconsistency across the batch	Moderate — a small group performs adequately; the rest are not closing the gap

3. Detailed Observations

3.1 Basic Telecom and Domain Knowledge

- The expectation set for the batch is a working understanding of eTOM (enhanced Telecom Operations Map) up to Level 3. In practice, several candidates were unable to explain even the basic purpose and structure of the framework.
- Candidates could not place eTOM within the broader Framework / TM Forum context, or distinguish between its Strategy, Infrastructure & Product; Operations; and Enterprise Management domains.
- Foundational telecom vocabulary — OSS/BSS, order-to-cash, service assurance, fulfilment — was either absent or used incorrectly.
- Where a candidate did recall the framework, it was recited as memorised text rather than applied to a business scenario.

3.2 Certifications Claimed Without Corresponding Depth

- A significant number of candidates have listed certifications on their profiles but were unable to explain the syllabus, the core concepts covered, or why they pursued the certification.
- Follow-up questions on certified topics were answered incorrectly, which reflects poorly on credibility — a claimed credential that cannot be defended is a net negative in an interview, not a neutral.
- Candidates could not link certifications to a career narrative or to the roles they are targeting.

3.3 Answer Structure and Business Vocabulary

- Answers are delivered as unorganised streams of thought. There is no discernible opening position, supporting logic or closing summary.
- Standard structuring approaches — STAR, SCQA, issue trees, hypothesis-first reasoning — are not being used, and in several cases are not known.
- Use of business jargon and professional terminology is minimal. Candidates describe commercial situations in everyday language, which signals a lack of exposure to business context.
- Responses tend to be either far too long and meandering, or too short to demonstrate any depth.

3.4 Work Experience and Summer Internship Articulation

- Candidates with prior work experience are unable to quantify their contribution. Impact is described qualitatively (“I helped the team”, “I improved the process”) with no numbers attached — no cost saved, time reduced, volume handled, revenue influenced or accuracy improved.
- The same weakness appears in the description of summer internship work.
- Work experience is not being mapped to any recognised framework. Candidates should be able to position what they did against relevant models — for example eTOM or ITIL for process work, Porter’s Five Forces or the 4Ps for market-facing work, or a value chain view for operations — and are not doing so.
- There is no clear articulation of the problem statement, the candidate’s specific role within the team, the actions taken, and the outcome.

3.5 Structured Thinking, Case Studies and Guesstimates

- This was identified as the single largest gap. Candidates are not thinking in a structured manner when presented with an open problem.
- Case study practice is effectively absent. Candidates do not clarify the problem, do not lay out a structure before solving, and jump directly to unsupported conclusions.
- Guesstimates are not being practised at all. Candidates are unable to break a problem into drivers, state assumptions explicitly, or sanity-check their final number.
- There is little evidence of MECE thinking, top-down decomposition, or the ability to defend an assumption when challenged.

3.6 Technical Knowledge

- Technical fundamentals are weak across the board. Candidates are comfortable naming tools and technologies but cannot explain how they work or when they should be applied.
- Answers do not go beyond surface-level definitions; second-level probing questions consistently expose the gap.
- Candidates are unable to connect technical concepts to business outcomes — which is the specific skill the roles being targeted require.

- Basic concepts relevant to the domain (architecture, data flow, integration, process automation) are not held with confidence.

3.7 Articulation and Communication

- Articulation is a standalone weakness independent of content. Even where a candidate knows the answer, it is not communicated clearly.
- Common issues observed: filler words, incomplete sentences, poor pace, low confidence in delivery, and an inability to hold a point of view under mild challenge.
- Candidates do not listen to the full question before beginning to answer, resulting in responses that address a different question.
- Professional and executive-level communication — concise, structured, outcome-oriented — is not yet in evidence.

3.8 Situational and Behavioural Responses

- Situational responses were rated very poor. Candidates respond to hypothetical workplace scenarios with generic statements rather than a reasoned course of action.
- There is no visible decision-making framework: stakeholders are not identified, trade-offs are not weighed, and no prioritisation logic is offered.
- Candidates avoid taking a position on conflict, escalation or ethical scenarios, defaulting to safe non-answers.
- Behavioural answers are not anchored in real personal examples, which makes them unconvincing.

3.9 Attitude, Ownership and Emerging Technology

- Reviewers described the overall approach of the batch as laid-back. Preparation appears to be reactive and driven by immediate deadlines rather than sustained effort.
- There is a visible reluctance to learn beyond the prescribed syllabus.
- Emerging technology areas — most notably Agentic AI, which is currently one of the most talked-about areas in industry — are not being tracked. Candidates were unaware of the term or unable to discuss its relevance to their target roles.
- Awareness of industry news, recent deals, and technology trends relevant to the sector is low.

3.10 Inconsistency Across the Batch and Visibility of Improvement

- A small group of candidates is performing at a marginally better level and is holding up to expectations. This group is the exception, not the norm.
- Candidates who received weak reviews in earlier interactions have not shown measurable improvement in PPM 1.
- Faculty are putting in the effort on preparation and training, but that effort is not reflected in interview outcomes — the improvement is not visible to reviewers.

- This indicates that the gap lies primarily in individual practice and ownership between sessions, rather than in the support being provided.

4. Why This Matters

Each of the gaps above maps directly to a screening criterion used in live placement processes. Taken together they create a compounding risk:

Gap	Consequence in a Live Process
No structured thinking	Elimination at the case / problem-solving round
Weak domain and eTOM knowledge	Loss of credibility for domain-specific roles; disqualification on technical screening
Undefended certifications	Perceived as profile padding; damages trust in the entire CV
Unquantified work experience	Candidate is treated as a fresher despite prior experience; lower role and compensation banding
Poor articulation	Strong content is not registered by the panel
Weak situational responses	Failure at the behavioural / fitment round, which is often the final gate
No awareness of emerging tech	Read as low curiosity and low learning agility

5. Recommended Corrective Actions

5.1 Immediate (next two to four weeks)

- Mandatory daily practice of one guesstimate and one mini-case per candidate, submitted in written structured form.
- Re-teach and then test eTOM to Level 3, with a closed-book assessment. Candidates must be able to place a business scenario within the framework, not just recite it.
- Every candidate to rewrite their CV bullet points with quantified outcomes. No bullet to be accepted without a number or a defined measure of impact.
- A certification audit: each candidate to defend every certification claimed, in a five-minute viva. Certifications that cannot be defended should be removed from the CV.

5.2 Short term (four to eight weeks)

- Structured answering drills using STAR and SCQA, with recorded responses and peer review.
- A working glossary of business and telecom terminology, with candidates required to use it in mock responses.
- Mapping exercise: each candidate maps their work experience and summer internship to at least one recognised framework and presents it.

- Situational response workshops covering stakeholder management, prioritisation, conflict and ethical judgement, with a defined decision framework.

5.3 Ongoing

- A weekly industry and emerging technology briefing, with Agentic AI, applied AI and automation covered explicitly, followed by candidate-led discussion.
- Individual improvement tracking: reviewer scores captured after each mock so that progress — or the absence of it — is visible and attributable.
- Peer mentoring, pairing the small group of better-performing candidates with those who have received consistently weak reviews.
- A follow-up alumni review round to verify whether the gaps identified here have actually closed.

6. Closing Note

The feedback in this document is direct because the reviewers were direct. The distance between the batch's current performance and the expected standard is significant, but every gap listed here is closable within a single preparation cycle — provided that practice becomes consistent and individually owned rather than session-dependent.

The clearest signal from PPM 1 is that knowing the material is not the constraint; structuring it, quantifying it and communicating it is. That is where effort should now be concentrated.